MRC GHANA 2027
CATEGORY INFORMATION SHEET

Football 3×3

Remote-controlled robot football

29–30 January 2027 · Accra, Ghana · Venue to be announced

The current official H.E.R.O. rules take precedence
This sheet is a plain-English summary prepared by the MRC Ghana 2027 organisers. Always check the official rules before building or competing: https://www.he-ro.gr/mrc-soccer

Sport overview

Football 3×3 is robot football on a compact pitch. Each side is an alliance of three teams, each controlling one remote-controlled robot.

Robots must use a motor-driven kicking mechanism to shoot. Teams win through good robot design, accurate driving and alliance teamwork.

Competition objective

- Score more goals than the opposing alliance in five-minute matches.
- Design a robust robot with an effective, motor-driven kicker.
- Advance from the group stage through the knockout rounds.

Age eligibility

One division; all robot types compete together. Each age category competes separately.

Age category	Published ages
Kids	10 to 12 years
Teens / Senior	12+ to 18 years
Adults	18+ years

Team requirements

- Teams of 2 to 3 members. Individual entries are not accepted.
- Each team names one Technician — the only team member allowed in the waiting and competition area. The Technician may change between attempts or matches.
- Every team member must be at least 10 years old.
- Each team needs a coach aged 20 or over. A coach must bring one assistant for every three teams they register.
- One robot per team. Robots may not be swapped during the competition or shared between teams.
- An alliance is made of three teams, which the official rules state must belong to the same school or institution.
- Each alliance's robots carry a visible shared identifier (flag, label or colours), checked at inspection.

Format and scoring

- Pitch: about 2.36 × 1.14 m with a low perimeter barrier and green surface.
- Matches last five minutes with no half-time; the clock does not stop.
- Group stage, then quarter-finals, semi-finals, a Small Final and a Final.
- Drawn knockout matches go to a two-minute golden goal, then penalties.
- A goal counts when the whole ball crosses the goal line.
- Group stage: 3 points for a win, 1 for a draw, 0 for a loss; ties separated by goals scored, then conceded.
- 1st, 2nd and 3rd place are announced in each age category.

Robot and equipment requirements

- Remote-controlled robot (remote or app). Venue Wi-Fi is not available to teams.
- Maximum footprint 20 × 20 cm, weight 700–800 g, height up to 15 cm.
- A motor-driven kicking mechanism that stays within 20 × 20 cm when fully extended.
- Up to 4 motors and a single controller, plus a start/stop button.
- Ball: LEGO Mindstorms ball, 52 mm diameter.
- No holding or carrying the ball; banned items include pneumatics, glue, suction and deliberately detachable parts.

Preparation checklist

- [ ] Form an alliance of three teams from your school or institution.
- [ ] Check robot size, weight (700–800 g) and height; test the kicker at full extension.
- [ ] Practise driving, passing and shooting with a 52 mm LEGO ball.
- [ ] Prepare spare parts and batteries for quick repairs between matches.
- [ ] Agree your alliance identifier (flag or colours).

Safety notes

- Deliberately trying to damage an opponent results in a red card.
- Technicians may not touch robots during play without the referee's permission.
- Rule ZERO applies: if you are not sure something is allowed, assume it is not and ask the organisers.

Awaiting clarification

- The official rules publish age bands but do not state how age is calculated (for example, age on competition day or by year of birth), and adjacent bands share boundary ages (for example '10 to 12' and '12+'). The Ghana organising committee will confirm how ages are applied before registration closes.
- The bracket used for the group stage is shown only in images on the official page; the exact format will depend on the number of alliances.

Registration guidance

- Register through the official MRC Ghana 2027 registration application: https://www.mrcghana.com/register
- Have your team name, team members, coach details and chosen sport(s) ready.
- Registration fees and deadlines: to be announced.
- Participant information is collected only through the official registration application.
- Questions: partnerships@makersplacegh.com

Official rules and source

Official H.E.R.O. rules
https://www.he-ro.gr/mrc-soccer

Source checked: 14 October 2026
Sheet version: 2026-10-14
Category page: https://www.mrcghana.com/categories/football